

Signal of the week

EU Data Act Article 3 access-by-design rule bites on connected-vehicle OEMs

From 12 September 2026, all connected products sold in the EU, including vehicles, must let users access and redirect their data.

Why it matters to Cubic³ — Every EU OEM programme now needs an audited data-access path — our orchestration and consent layer becomes a compliance line item.

Sources: Automotive IQ (2026-09-12) · Grape Up (2026-09-12)

Where the activity was

	SDV	Connect-ivity	AI	Data mgmt	Digital twins
Automotive	6	3	3	3	0
Robotics / AV	4	2	5	2	0
Energy	2	1	2	3	2
Agri / industrial	4	1	5	1	1

Qualifying items this week (score ≥ 6): none 1-2 3-5 6+

The read-across

The week's 18 qualifying items cluster around one theme: the software layer is being locked down by regulators and standardised by consortia simultaneously.

The heat-map shows SDV lit across every domain and connectivity notably thin outside automotive — a gap the Viasat-Space42, Iridium NTN Direct and SGP.32 announcements are moving to close.

60

items screened

18

qualified (score ≥ 6)

6

account-relevant

● Automotive OEMs

SDV

Nissan and Honda agree to standardise ECUs, in-vehicle OS and middleware

On 31 August 2026, Nissan and Honda formalised a joint development agreement covering ECUs, vehicle OS and middleware for their next-generation software-defined vehicles, mirroring a parallel European effort by Volkswagen, BMW, Mercedes-Benz and Stellantis.

So what — Two named accounts are consolidating their software stack; connectivity proposals must now clear both companies' shared architecture.

MarkLines, 2026-08-31

● Robotics and autonomous vehicles

Connectivity Data mgmt AI

FCC adds foreign-produced advanced robots to national-security Covered List

The FCC's Third Report and Order, adopted July 2026, adds foreign-produced humanoids, quadrupeds, AMRs and connected service robots to its Covered List, citing a 2026 remote-access vulnerability and a Unitree fleet exploit.

So what — US robot fleet operators now need a Western-vetted connectivity and data path — a direct opening for our orchestration stack in the humanoid and AMR segments.

K&L Gates, 2026-08-03

Connectivity SDV

Verizon becomes US connectivity provider for BMW vehicles via KDDI global platform

All newly manufactured BMW Group vehicles now use Verizon for US cellular service, routed through KDDI's global connected-vehicle platform, which handles eSIM profile management before hand-off.

So what — A named account is running eSIM orchestration through a direct competitor; the counter-pitch must be a like-for-like global platform with better VAS.

Atomic Mobile, 2026-07-06

SDV AI

NHTSA orders Tesla to answer 21 sworn questions on Cybercab self-certification

NHTSA's Special Order AQ26002, issued 10 September 2026, required Tesla to answer 21 sworn questions on how the steering-wheel-free, camera-only Cybercab was self-certified against federal safety standards.

So what — Regulatory scrutiny of camera-only autonomy will slow US robotaxi rollouts, reopening the door for connectivity-backed remote supervision and V2X-based safety layers.

NHTSA / Basenor, 2026-09-30

● Energy

SDV Data mgmt

Volkswagen and Elli confirm Q4 2026 launch of integrated V2G package in Germany

Volkswagen and its energy subsidiary Elli will launch a bundled vehicle-to-grid product in Germany in Q4 2026, combining an EV, app, electricity tariff, smart meter, bidirectional charger and automated energy-management software on Germany's new MiSpeL technical framework.

So what — This is the first commercial V2G bundle from a global OEM — Fleet Wallet has a clear wedge as the bidirectional settlement rail between driver, CPO and utility.

Volkswagen Group Newsroom, 2026-04-16

SDV Data mgmt Connectivity

Germany's MiSpeL V2G technical framework goes live, enabling commercial bidirectional charging

Germany's MiSpeL framework, setting interoperability and metering rails for commercial V2G, entered force in April 2026 following the November 2025 Energy Industry Act amendment removing double grid fees for EV storage.

So what — Germany is now the reference V2G market; our metering, identity and settlement layer needs a MiSpeL conformance statement in the next sales pack.

Eleport, 2026-05-07

● Agri and industrial OEMs

SDV AI

Applied Intuition extends 'Dana' agentic-AI SDV workflow to mining, construction and ag OEMs

Applied Intuition published details of Dana, an agentic AI unifying vehicle OS processes, OTA, sensor integration and energy management in one workflow, explicitly extended to mining, construction and agricultural vehicles to compress engineering handoffs across the software lifecycle.

So what — Off-highway OEMs are being handed an automotive-grade SDV toolchain; our connectivity and data-access layer should be pre-integrated with Dana before AGCO or CNH ask.

Applied Intuition, 2026-08-13

AI SDV

Komatsu and AIM Intelligent Machines move autonomous dozers and excavators to commercial deployment

Komatsu, its EARTHRAIN subsidiary and AIM Intelligent Machines progressed their autonomous bulldozer and hydraulic excavator programme into commercial deployment at US customer jobsites, with a Japan launch planned for 2027.

So what — A named account is scaling autonomy across brownfield fleets — the retrofit connectivity and telemetry pipe is a direct proposal opportunity now.

International Mining, 2026-07-31

● Deals and partnerships logged this week

Who	With	What	Domain	Relevance
Volkswagen Group	Elli	Q4 2026 launch of integrated V2G package for German private customers	Energy	Fleet Wallet
Nissan	Honda	Joint development of standard ECUs, in-vehicle OS and middleware for next-gen SDVs	Automotive	Prospect
BMW Group	KDDI and Verizon	US cellular connectivity for newly built BMW vehicles through KDDI global platform	Automotive	Competitive
Komatsu / EARTHRAIN	AIM Intelligent Machines	Commercial deployment of autonomous dozers and excavators at US jobsites	Agri / industrial	Customer

Watch list

US auto alliance urges Congress to ban Chinese vehicles by year-end. Watch: a ban would harden trusted connectivity and data-handling as a US procurement requirement — a helpful tailwind for Western orchestration platforms.

Tata Communications and Tata Motors put 5G into Sierra.ev via MOVE platform. Watch: Tata is bundling captive telco with captive OEM — a model competitors will imitate in adjacent markets.

Nuvve: fleets and utilities now the primary V2G adopters after US tax-credit lapse. Watch: the V2G buyer in the US is now the fleet or utility, not the driver — our energy pitch should be reshaped accordingly.